one-fifth of the continent is covered by arid soils of various types in which agriculture is risky without irrigation.

5. The Strait of Magellan, also called the Straits of Magellan, is a navigable sea route in southern Chile separating mainland South America to the north and Tierra del Fuego to the south. The strait is considered the most important natural passage between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans. It has been traversed by explorers and others throughout modern history. It connects Argentina and Chile.
6. Santiago experiences Mediterranean type of climate.
7. The only South American country which shares maritime borders with Pacific ocean and Caribbean sea is Colombia.
8. The Mato Grosso Plateau (Planalto do Mato Grosso) is a plateau in central Brazil occupying most of the state of Mato Grosso. It contains mostly savanna and woodland.
9. The Transandine Railway which operated from Mendoza in Argentina, across the Andes mountain range via the Uspallata Pass, to Santa Rosa de Los Andes in Chile, a distance of 248 km.
10. Patagonia desert is largest desert in South America.
11. Angel Falls is a waterfall in Venezuela. It is the world's highest uninterrupted waterfall.
12. The salt lake Laguna del Carbon is regarded as the lowest point in the entire continent of South America.
13. Coordinates of South America: 8.7832° S, 55.4915° W.
14. The Atacama Desert of northern Chile has large deposits of nitrates, which were used for fertilizers and in the munitions industry until they were largely replaced by synthetic fertilizers and atmospheric nitrogen.
15. The potato, which originated in the high Andes, became a dietary staple of many European nations.
16. Venezuela is one of the top 10 largest oil reserves containing country in the world and top among South American countries.
17. Isthmus of Panama divides North America and South America.
18. Highest active volcano in South America is Mt Cotopaxi.
19.